

Case Study Assignment

Enterprise Reporting & Automation Strategy Using Microsoft Tools

Duration

120 Minutes

Objective

The objective of this case study is to help learners understand how modern organizations use Microsoft Power Platform and SQL Server Reporting Services (SSRS) to solve business problems related to data analysis, reporting, workflow automation, and business applications.

Learners will analyze a business scenario and propose a reporting and automation solution using the appropriate Microsoft tools.

Case Scenario

Company: RetailHub Pvt Ltd

Industry: Retail and E-commerce

RetailHub operates 50 retail stores and an online marketplace across multiple cities. The company collects large volumes of data from different systems including:

- Sales transactions
- Inventory management systems
- Customer orders
- Supplier databases
- Finance and billing systems

Currently, the company faces the following challenges:

1. Store managers receive daily sales reports manually through spreadsheets.
2. Finance teams manually prepare monthly financial reports.

3. Inventory managers do not have real-time visibility of stock levels.
4. Customer support receives repetitive queries about order status and delivery updates.
5. Management wants interactive dashboards to analyze performance across regions.

The company leadership wants to modernize their reporting and automation infrastructure using Microsoft tools.

Task for Learners

You are hired as a Technology Consultant to recommend a solution using:

- Microsoft Power Platform
- SQL Server Reporting Services (SSRS)

Your goal is to design a high-level solution architecture explaining how these tools can solve the company's problems.

Deliverables (Submission Work)

Learners must submit a 2–3 page document OR 6–8 slide presentation covering the following sections.

Part 1: Problem Analysis (20 Minutes)

Identify and explain the key challenges faced by the organization.

Questions to address:

1. What are the major data and reporting problems faced by RetailHub?
2. Why are spreadsheets not an ideal solution for enterprise reporting?

3. What operational inefficiencies are occurring due to manual processes?

Expected Output

A short explanation (5–6 bullet points).

Part 2: Power Platform Solution Design (30 Minutes)

Explain how the Microsoft Power Platform can help solve the company's problems.

Questions to address:

1. How can Power BI help management analyze business performance?
2. How can Power Apps be used to improve internal business processes?
3. How can Power Automate help reduce manual tasks?
4. How can Power Virtual Agents improve customer support?

Expected Output

A table similar to the following:

Business Problem	Power Platform Tool	Proposed Solution
Lack of business insights	Power BI	Interactive sales dashboard
Manual HR processes	Power Apps	Employee management app
Repetitive approval process	Power Automate	Automated workflow

Customer queries	Power Virtual Agents	Chatbot
------------------	----------------------	---------

Part 3: SSRS Reporting Strategy (20 Minutes)

Explain where SSRS should be used instead of Power BI.

Questions to answer:

1. What type of reports are best suited for SSRS?
2. Why is SSRS ideal for financial or operational reporting?
3. Give two examples of reports RetailHub could generate using SSRS.

Expected Output

Short explanation with examples such as:

- Invoice reports
- Daily store sales reports
- Financial statements
- Inventory summaries

Part 4: Tool Comparison (20 Minutes)

Create a comparison explaining when to use SSRS vs Power BI.

Expected Output

Criteria	SSRS	Power BI
----------	------	----------

Reporting type	Paginated	Interactive
Best use case	Operational reports	Business analytics
Visualization capability	Basic	Advanced
User interaction	Low	High

Explain which tool RetailHub should use for different reporting needs.

Part 5: Proposed Solution Architecture (20 Minutes)

Create a simple architecture diagram or explanation showing how the tools work together.

Example architecture flow:

Data Sources

SQL Server Database

Inventory System

Sales Database

↓

SSRS Reports for operational reporting

↓

Power BI Dashboards for analytics

↓

Power Apps for internal applications

↓

Power Automate for workflow automation



Power Virtual Agents for customer chatbot

Learners can submit this as:

- Simple diagram
- OR**
- Step-by-step architecture explanation
-

Final Reflection (10 Minutes)

Answer the following question:

Why is a combined approach using Power Platform and SSRS beneficial for modern enterprises?

Expected answer length:
100–150 words.

Evaluation Rubric

Criteria	Marks
Problem understanding	20
Power Platform solution design	25
SSRS reporting explanation	20

Tool comparison clarity	15
Architecture design	10
Final reflection	10

Total: 100 Marks

Expected Learning Outcomes

After completing this case study, learners will be able to:

- Understand the role of Power Platform in enterprise solutions
- Identify when to use SSRS vs Power BI
- Design basic reporting and automation architectures
- Apply theoretical knowledge to real-world business scenarios